

Bcho NAM Player

User Manual



Standalone + VST3 | Version 0.3.3

1. Overview

Bcho NAM Player is a portable guitar processor for Windows, macOS and Linux. It plays Neural Amp Modeler (.nam) models, cabinet impulse responses (.wav) and a reorderable effects chain. The standalone edition also owns the audio device; the VST3 receives audio and routing from the DAW.

2. Quick installation

Download the package for your system from the [latest release](#) and keep every file in the ZIP together.

- Windows: run BchoNAMPlayer.exe.
- macOS: open BchoNAMPlayer.app; choose Intel or Apple Silicon.
- Linux: launch the AppImage, making it executable if needed.

The initial package includes two demonstration NAM models in Models; no IRs are bundled. Add your own models and IRs from the centre display or drag them from the file manager. macOS packages are currently unsigned and not notarized.

3. Main panel

The head contains the **POWER** switch, input controls, tuner, amplifier controls and meters. The centre display is split into two equal zones: **NAM MODELS** and **IR FILES**. Each list shows four entries and adds scrolling when more are available.

Drag a knob vertically or horizontally to change it. Double-click any knob to restore its initial value: every control returns to 12 o'clock except **Gate**, which returns to 0 and disables the gate.

Input and amplifier controls

- **POWER**: enables or mutes the main processing path.
- **Input Gain**: level entering the NAM model.
- **Input Cali (Auto)**: compensates input level when the model provides `input_level_dbu`; otherwise no correction is applied.
- **Gate**: professional noise gate. At 0 it is fully bypassed. Increasing it raises the threshold; the detector uses a smoothed envelope, attack, hold and release to avoid abrupt cuts.
- **Bass, Mid, Treble, Presence**: four-band EQ after the NAM preamp.
- **IR Blend**: mixes the un-convolved signal with the cabinet-IR signal.
- **Master Vol**: main level after the player chain.
- **Output Gain**: final output gain.

At default values, MAIN is neutral and sounds the same as PRE. PRE is an independent reference tap and is unaffected by player controls.

4. Tuner

Enable **TUNER**. It always analyses the clean DI signal before gate, NAM and effects. The lights show whether the note is flat, in tune or sharp; the detected note is shown below. Standard and alternate tunings are available. For stable detection, play one isolated string at a useful level and allow noise to decay between notes.

5. NAM models and IRs

Use **BROWSE NAM** or drag a .nam file onto the centre list or the **PreAmp/Amp (NAM Model)** block. A1/A2 architecture is detected automatically. The up/down arrows navigate the current model folder and **TONE3000** opens the online browser and loads the selected model. Loading another NAM resets the controls and switches to their defaults.

Use **BROWSE IR** or drag a .wav file onto the centre list or the **IR** block. The list shows files from the folder containing the selected IR, and the arrows navigate that folder. The IR block stays bypassed until an IR is loaded. Mono and stereo IRs are prepared for the selected audio rate.

6. Effects rack

The rack opens above the amplifier. Drag blocks to change their order and click a block to enable or bypass it. Double-click opens the advanced editor; it closes with **X**, Escape or a click outside.

The **PREAMP** and **IR** anchors define the electrical position. Before **PREAMP** is in front of the amp; between **PREAMP** and **IR** is the effects loop; after **IR** is post-cabinet. The tuner is always first and is intentionally not shown in the rack. **NAM FX** adds an optional second NAM model as an overdrive/distortion pedal.

Each block provides three algorithms and six parameters:

Block	Types	Parameters
COMPRESSOR	Studio VCA, Optical, FET Punch	Threshold, Ratio, Attack, Release, Makeup, Mix
DELAY	Digital Studio, Tape Echo, Analog BBD	Time, Feedback, Mix, Tone, Mod, Level
CHORUS	Studio, Ensemble, Tri-Chorus	Rate, Depth, Mix, Delay, Feedback, Level
FLANGER	Analog, Through-Zero, Jet	Rate, Depth, Mix, Feedback, Manual, Level
PHASER	4 Stage, 8 Stage, 12 Stage	Rate, Depth, Mix, Feedback, Centre, Level
REVERB	Studio Room, Plate, Concert Hall	Size, Damping, Mix, Width, Freeze, Level
OCTAVER	Poly Clean, Classic Mono, Organ	Oct Down, Oct Up, Dry, Tone, Tracking, Level
PITCH SHIFTER	Studio, Low Latency, Vintage	Semitones, Mix, Window, Feedback, Fine, Level

Values are displayed with units in each block editor. Bypass, parameter and type changes are smoothed to prevent clicks; delay effects use interpolation and feedback is bounded for stable processing.

7. AUDIO SETUP — standalone only

Open **AUDIO SETUP** to select the audio system and driver, including ASIO on Windows; interface; active inputs and outputs; sample rate; buffer size; manufacturer control panel; and output routing.

Available taps are **MAIN** (processed), **PRE** (NAM without player controls or effects), **DI** (clean input) and **WET** (processed post-cab branch). **MAIN** defaults to outputs 1/2 when enabled. The last device and routing configuration is restored on the next launch. The VST3 does not show this panel because the DAW owns the audio device.

8. Settings, skins and updates

Click the gear icon in the right-hand corner of the speaker cabinet to open **SETTINGS**. It lets you:

- choose an installed skin for a temporary preview; it is not committed until you click **APPLY**;
- select another skin while preserving the exact positions of displays, knobs, scales and switches;
- view the installed application version;
- use **CHECK FOR UPDATES** to search manually for a newer release;

- enable or disable **CHECK ON STARTUP**, the automatic check performed when the app opens. A discreet LED shows its state, and the option lives inside Settings so it does not clutter the front panel.

Update checks only report published versions; they do not alter presets, models or audio without user confirmation. The VST3 keeps the controls, tuner, centre display, rack and skins, but does not show **AUDIO SETUP** because the DAW owns the device.

9. .bnpp presets

SAVE .BNPP creates a self-contained portable preset containing the XML state, main NAM, optional NAM pedal, IR, rack order, types, bypass states and all controls. **LOAD .BNPP** extracts its resources to a safe cache and restores the state. Audio-device settings are excluded so presets remain portable across computers and DAWs.

10. State and troubleshooting

The application restores the last NAM, IR and preset used. If there is no sound, check POWER, the selected device, active inputs, buffer size and INPUT VU level. If a NAM is silent, verify the file and its licence. For low latency, start with a small ASIO buffer and increase it if clicks occur.